

Contacts

Allotments Assoc	Nick Ford		01584 875834
Art Group	Geoff Trotter	Geoffrey.a.trotter@gmail.com	
Caring for God’ Little Acre	Barbara Mark		01568 780842
Church Wardens	Liz Mackay		07484 679671
	John Berry		01568 780321
Doctors			01584 831300
Evergreens	Sue Turner	sue.a.turner@gmail.com	01584 831324
Gardening Club	Nick Russel		01568 780678
Good Neighbour Scheme			07467 535503
Herefordshire Councillor	Cllr. Dan Hurcomb	dan.hurcomb@herefordshire.gov.uk	07792 882147
Land Drainage Group	David Lane		01568 78036
Orleton Footpath Maintenance Volunteers	Martin Bradford	emlmart@hotmail.com	01568 780151
Orleton Relief in Need	Barry Rogers		01584 831514
Orleton Junior Football Club	Mel Williams	cherry.brook@me.com	07511 920515
Orleton Toddlers	Bethan Jenkins	Bethan.I.edwards@hotmail.co.uk	07534 726222
Orleton Young Farmers Club	Bell Beaumont	orleyonyfc@hotmail.com	
Parish Council		clerk@orleton-pc.gov.uk	
Pre-School	Tara Morris		01568 780143
Primary School		admin@orleton.hereford.sch.uk	01568 780366
Primary School PTA	Nicola Goodman	nicolagoodman1989@gmail.com	
Rainbows	Carly Morgan		07788 236628
Recreation Association	Graham Shaw		01568 780783
Village Hall		bookings@orletonvillage.co.uk	01568 780583
WI	Sue Copson		01568 780956

www.orletonvillage.co.uk

ORLETON VILLAGE MAGAZINE



July 2026

How to be included in Orleton Village Magazine

This magazine will be published on the first day of each month on the Village Website:

www.orletonvillage.co.uk.

Notification of publication, together with a link, will be given on Nextdoor and Orleton Village Chat (Facebook)

Articles of general interest, club or association reports and advertisements for community events may be included without charge. Commercial advertisements are charged, dependent on size. (Rates available on request from:

orletonmagazine@gmail.com)

Small private sale advertisements may be accepted without charge if space allows

All content is accepted at the discretion of the editorial team. Articles that are disrespectful or prejudicial will not be accepted.

Copy should be submitted as Word or PDF files. If hard copy is submitted there may be a charge for scanning and input.

All copy must be accompanied by the name, address and telephone number of the author, although this will not be included unless incorporated into the article.

Articles for publication should be emailed to:

orletonmagazine@gmail.com by the 25th of the month prior to desired publication

Orleton Village Hall

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Orleton Village Hall has regular weekly activities to which new members are always welcome. Contact details can be found here...

Monday's

Orleton Toddlers Every Monday morning 10-11:45am
Contact: Bethan 07534 726222 or Charlotte 07964 981036

Orleton WI 2nd Monday of the month, October to March at 2:30pm
Contact: Sue Copson susancopson934@gmail.com

Tuesday's

Rainbows Every Tuesday in term time 4:30-5:30pm
Contact Kaye Harrison kayemharrison@yahoo.co.uk

Orleton Ramblers 2nd and 4th Tuesday of month - Meet at Village Hall 9:50am, leaving at 10:00am
Contact: Jan Greatrex tandjgreatrex@gmail.com

Gardening Club Last Tuesday of the month 7:30-9:30pm
Contact: Monica 01568 613861 orletongc@hotmail.co.uk

Yoga Every Tuesday evening 6:30-7:30pm (Commences again in September)
Contact Rosie 07834 851656

Wednesday's

Coffee Morning Every Wednesday at 10:30am-12:00 (Closed in August)
Contact: Cathy Hardwick cathy.hardwick@hotmail.co.uk

Library Last Wednesday of the month at Coffee Morning 10:30-11:45am
Contact: Sue Rogers 01584 831514

Sequence Dancing 3rd Wednesday of the month – 2-3pm
Contact: Amy Whitby amyelwynwhitby@gmail.com

Thursday's

Evergreens Last Thursday of the month – 2-4pm
Contact: Sue Turner sue.a.turner@gmail.com

Craft Group 1st and 3rd Thursday of each month 1:30-4:30pm (No sessions in August)
Contact Sue Turner 01584 831324 sue.a.turner@gmail.com

Table Tennis Every Thursday at 7:30pm
Contact: Geoff Lewin geoffnlewin@gmail.com

Orleton Village Hall is available for private bookings

Contact Barry Gandy 01568 780583 or bookings@orletonvillage.co.uk

All entries are, as far as we know, correct at the time of going to print.



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Advertising in this magazine

**Club and association events
and other activities open to local residents – FREE**

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Quarter page £15 per year**

Editorial

As the school holidays approach some residents may have been thinking about a holiday in the warmth of the tropical sun.

However, the recent UK heat wave has made that prospect seem much less attractive. Perhaps the Norwegian Fiords or an Antarctic Cruise would be a cooler option.



Despite the challenges of the climate Orleton organisations continue to provide activities and events for the enjoyment of local residents.

The Orleton Village Fete will be held on 5th July with a wide range of stalls and activities.

Orleton & District Gardening Club will be holding their Annual Show on 15th August.

As the Coffee Morning in the Village Hall takes a summer break the Wednesday Coffee Morning will be held in St George's Church during the month of August. All welcome.

Flood Works

Herefordshire Council has given planning approval for the creation of three seasonal ponds and associated works to mitigate flooding of the downstream fields at Ashley Moor Farm.

As it has been surface water running off these fields across the B4361 and up Millbrook Way that has been a major contributor to Orleton's flooding, this will hopefully make a significant improvement to the situation.

We are grateful to the landowner for their involvement in this important project.

Road Works

As white markings have appeared around some of the more atrocious potholes on the said B4361 their days may be numbered!

Literary Works

Orleton Village Magazine welcomes contributions of general interest, factual or fiction to a total of 550 words

Report on Orleton St George's Flower Festival

On Saturday 6th and Sunday 7th June, St George's was thrilled to host a Flower Festival.

Themed around celebrating 100 years of broadcast television, the displays were wonderfully varied and creative, and – between them – represented programmes covering every decade of broadcast television. There was also a timeline summarizing some of the key developments in television over the 100 years.

These pictures just give a small flavour of what were some fantastic displays.

Thank you once again to everyone who took part in any way – be that making the displays, making or serving cakes, helping move furniture, or playing the piano. And thank you to everyone who came.

Thank you to everyone for helping create a super event, with a lovely atmosphere.



Orleton Church & Chapel News (July 2026)

Update

June saw some interesting Church services, as we explored the journeys of the apostles as they took on the Christian ministry following Christ's ascension to heaven. From traditional sermons to craft and drama in our Family Services, it was a real pleasure to come together as a Church family.

June also saw St George's beautifully decorated for the Flower Festival – there is a full report on this elsewhere, but just to say a huge thank you once again to everyone involved in making it such a wonderful weekend. We were also delighted to host the Ludlow Male Voice Choir, whose voices filled the church beautifully.

In July, we continue with our usual pattern of Church services, both traditional morning services and more informal services in the afternoons, as detailed in the table below.

Social activities to look out for in July include:

- Pizza & Games evening, Friday 3rd July, 6-8pm, St George's Church
- Village Fete, Sunday 5th July, midday-4pm, on the Rec

More detail on these events can be found in the adverts elsewhere in the magazine.

Updates on our other activities, including an update on our Family Services, Prayer Group, the Orleton History Group, Singing for Fun, Open the Book, food bank donations, and the 100 Club winners, can be found in our full newsletter, at: <https://stgeorgesorleton.org.uk/news/news>, and click on 'Church & Chapel News'.



July 2026 Services & Times at St George's & Chapel

Date	Time	Location	Service	Readings
Sunday 5th July 5 th Sunday after Trinity	9.30am	St George's	BCP Holy Communion	Genesis 24.34-38, 42-49, 58-67 Romans 7.15-25a Matthew 11.16-19, 25-30
Sunday 12th July 6 th Sunday after Trinity	10.30am	Chapel	Chapel Service, Rev'd Richard Hall, Holy Communion	Genesis 25.19-34 Romans 8.1-11
	3pm	St George's	Family Service, craft-focused	Matthew 13.1-9, 18-23
Sunday 19th July 7 th Sunday after Trinity	11am	St George's	Common Worship Holy Communion	Genesis 28.10-19a Romans 8.12-25 Matthew 13.24-30, 36-43
Sunday 26th July 8 th Sunday after Trinity	10.30am	Chapel	Chapel Service, Rev'd Denise Hargreaves	Genesis 29.15-28 Romans 8.26-39
	3pm	St George's	Family Service, drama-focused	Matthew 13.31-33, 44-52

Further information

For further information about Church, Chapel, services or activities, or if you would like to get involved either socially or as a member of the congregation then please contact:

Matthew Burns (Vicar, St George's): 01568 614399, teamvicarwest@leominsterteam.org.uk

Rev Denise Hargreaves (Methodist Minister): 01584 318628, dkah26@gmail.com, Ludlow Church Office 01584 879233

Also, why not check out the St George's website: <https://stgeorgesorleton.org.uk/>

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- APPOINTMENTS FOR VIEWING WITHOUT OBLIGATION CAN BE ARRANGED TO SUIT YOUR COMMITMENTS.
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- YOU CAN CHOOSE YOUR OWN CATERER TO USE OUR EXCEPTIONAL KITCHEN AND YOUR OWN BAR PROVIDER.

Orleton Good Neighbour Scheme

The Good Neighbour Scheme supports our community using a team of volunteers to help people who are experiencing difficulty in their own homes essentially, by just doing things that good neighbours do for each other.

Examples of how the scheme can help:

- Fetching prescriptions
- Occasional lifts to the surgery or hospital
- Shopping and running errands, such as posting a letter.
- Practical tasks around the home, such as changing a light bulb or hanging a picture

- **Contact Number 07467 535503**

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July Family Services

All in St George's Church

Join us for an informal, relaxed, interactive service involving craft or drama, followed by a light snack

Sunday 12th July, 3pm
(craft focused)

Sunday 26th July, 3pm
(drama focused)



PIZZA AND GAMES

FRIDAY 3 JULY 6-8PM
ST GEORGE'S CHURCH

FRIDAY 7 AUG
A BREAK FOR THE HOLIDAYS!

WE'LL BE BACK 4TH SEPTEMBER

For all those who enjoy traditional family games, card games, newer strategy games, or all three



Orleton Village Shop & Post Office

	Shop	Post Office
Mon- Fri	0745-1800	0745-1800
Sat	0830-1230	0830-1230
Sun	0830-1230	Closed

Whenever possible stock is sourced from local suppliers and below is a small selection;

- Tudge's bacon and sausages and hams (from Richard's Castle)
- Locally made cheeses, cakes and bread
- Variety of wines, beer and spirits
- Sweets, newspapers, magazines and local information
- Fresh fruit and vegetables
- Pet food
- Cards and stationery
- Amazon and Evri collection and drop-off
- Plants
- The shop also stocks all the household basics and a good range of Fairtrade and eco-friendly products.

Post office services include;

- Personal Banking
- Foreign Currency Exchange
- Pensions and Allowances and much more

Singing for Fun



Enjoy singing but want to just sing for fun? Why not join us at St George's 11am Friday mornings?

We sing old, well-known classics so no need to read music. All welcome, whether you want to hum, sing, or just listen.

Please just come along, or contact John Berry (jsberry47@gmail.com, 01568 782321) or Liz Mackay (e.e.mackay@gmail.com, or drop into Orleton shop)

Grafted Apple trees

2-3 year old named dessert, cookers, cider varieties

In pots - £20 (discount for bulk)

Trees in pots are easy to look after until you've decided where to plant them!

Discovery, Ashmead's Kernel, Russets, and many more...

Root stock: M25 vigorous; M111 & MM106 semi-vigorous

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www.applewoodcourses.com



Orleton and District
Gardening Club

45th ANNUAL SHOW

on Saturday 15th August at



Orleton Village Hall



OPEN CLASSES - Anyone can enter

Including: HEAVIEST MARROW COMPETITION - START SOWING NOW!

Who can ferment the best cider? Challenge your friends and neighbours.

OTHER OPEN CLASSES

Alcohol-based Cordial; Heaviest Potato; Longest Runner Bean; Most Amusing shaped Vegetable or Fruit JUST 10p PER ENTRY

Save the Date - Saturday 15th August - staging 10 - 11.30 am, viewing 1.30 - 3.30pm For more details and show rules see SHOW SCHEDULE at

www.orletongardeningclub.co.uk

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Orleton Evergreens



Our 2026 programme is well under way:

The next few months see us out and about:

July 30th Outing to St Fagan's Museum of History, Cardiff £26 (£28 non-members), maximum 30 people

August 27th Outing to Gloucestershire & Warwickshire Steam Railway, Cheltenham £37 (£39 non-members)

ALL WELCOME

Further details:

sue.a.turner@gmail.com 01584 831324

Orleton History Group

On 27th June, James Turtle shared the research he has been doing into 'the poor are always with us': for more than 300 years the people of Orleton paid an annual Poor Rate - a tax on land and houses to relieve poverty among its parishioners. What help did they get? Who ended up in the workhouse? His talk is yet to take place as I write, but all the little hints and titbits he has shared suggest it will be fascinating! We take a break for summer holidays in July, so our next talk is on:

Saturday 29th August at 2.30pm, St George's Church: Linda Crichton, a Hereford Tour Guide, will present a discussion of iconic buildings in Hereford City Centre that reflect different periods of development and styles of architecture through the centuries from Medieval, Jacobean, Georgian to Victorian. Some you've seen, some may hold a few surprises!

Saturday 26th September at 2.30pm, St George's Church: following his very popular talk on PTSD last year, Peter Naish returns to talk on his favourite topic of hypnosis. Believe it or not, hypnosis has been around since the time of the Ancient Egyptians. Down the ages the effects have been ascribed to the power of the gods, to magnetism and to . . . well a denial that there are any effects! Now you can come and hear the history and the truth. By the way, Peter promises he won't make any of the audience come to the front and behave like a headless chicken or the like!

You can read reports on previous talks at the history group page at: www.stgeorgesorleton.org.uk (and then click on 'Orleton History Group'). You can also find, at the same web address, the reports on the research undertaken so far into the lives of the men on the Orleton War Memorial.

If you would like further information about the group, please contact Liz Mackay on e.e.mackay@gmail.com, or 07484 679671.

Coffee Morning

Every Wednesday – Orleton Village Hall 10.30 – 12.00*

Pop along, meet your friends & make new ones too. Parents and Grandparents are welcome to join us, with toddlers. We have a small selection of toys for them to play with.

We have a good choice of freshly-baked homemade goodies including gluten & dairy free, all slices are currently only £1 each. Beverages including Fairtrade are £1 for a cuppa with a free refill.

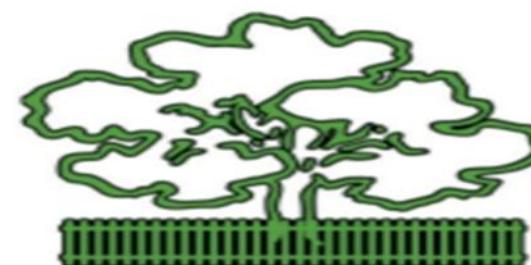
*Please note that we do not open throughout August, and we have two weeks off during the Christmas holidays.



- Visiting Library – last Wednesday of the month
- A relaxed informal group with no membership fees
- Foodbank box for local foodbank
- We make charitable donations to local groups



Are you a local group who would like to run a fundraising coffee morning? Please Contact our Chair Cathy Hardwick via email at cathy.hardwick@hotmail.co.uk



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Orleton Charity Quiz Nights

September 8th	Maidenhead	November 16th	Village Hall
October 13th	Boot Inn	December 8th	Maidenhead

All proceeds go to support local organisations in Orleton Village or recognised National Charities.

Special Event: John Robbins Memorial Quiz at Orleton Village Hall on a Saturday evening. Watch for the date!

Teams of up to six members. 7.30 for a 8.00pm start
Pre-booking of tables at:
the Boot (01568 780228) and the Maidenhead (01584 831686)
is strongly advised

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Orleton Art Group

Are you artistic or do you fancy trying your hand at painting and drawing? If so come and join us. We meet Wednesday afternoons from 2.00 until 4.30pm at Yarpole Village Hall.

For more information, please email Larry Turner, laurencepturner@gmail.com or Geoff Trotter, geoffrey.a.trotter@gmail.com

Or telephone Larry on 01584 831324



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ORLETON WI

Our June meeting welcomed three members of the Ludlow Community First Responders, a team of volunteers, who demonstrated CPR (Cardiopulmonary Resuscitation) and how to use a defibrillator. This is an emergency lifesaving procedure performed when a person's heart stops beating or they stop breathing.

In Orleton we are very fortunate to have three defibrillators - at the School, The Boot and the Surgery. In an emergency, the first step is to



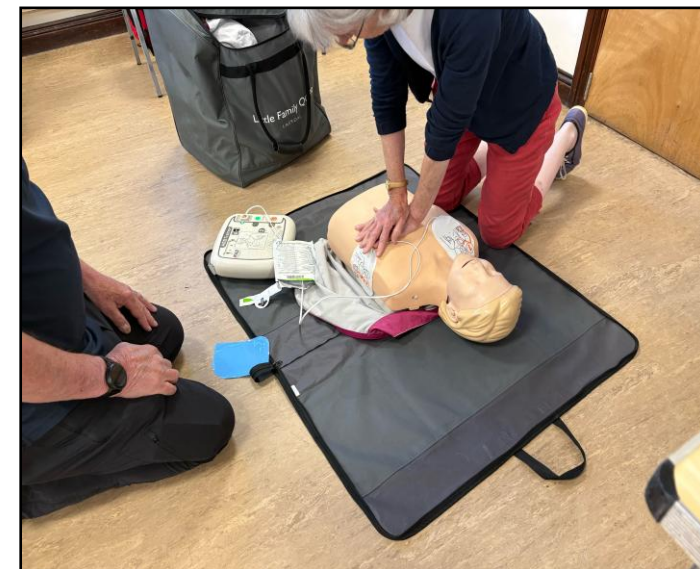
We had the opportunity to perform CPR and use a defibrillator on a model - quite a strenuous task!

Mark also showed us how to put someone into the recovery position.

The Community First Responders are a vital link in rural areas as they will invariably arrive before the emergency services.

This was a most informative meeting where we all learnt a very valuable skill.

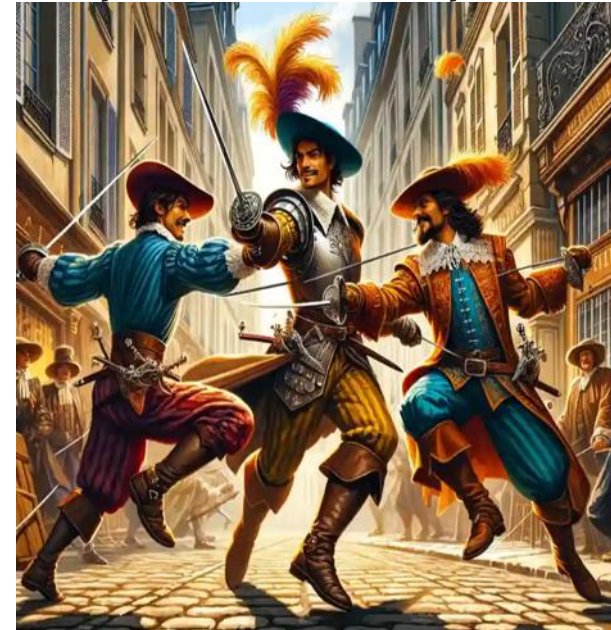
Our next meeting will be our strawberry cream tea on Monday 13th July.



perform CPR before sending for a defibrillator; should the latter be required, following a 999 call you would be given a PIN number to access the machine (this to stop theft).

Three Musketeers, Aymestrey

All for One - and One for All!



This summer, Illyria Outdoor Theatre will be performing The Three Musketeers at Yatton Court, Aymestrey on Friday 31st July at 7pm.

Yatton Court is an 18th Century manor house and the performance, befitting the occasion, will take place in its grounds

Set against a sweeping panorama of 17th century France at war, the Three Musketeers is a whirlwind of excitement, comedy and ingenious storytelling. Romance! Intrigue! Murder! Betrayal! Revenge...! It's got the lot!

With a reputation for staging some of the finest swordplay in the business, Illyria's The Three Musketeers promises to be more dazzling than ever!

So, bring a picnic and a seat and immerse yourself in this electrifying experience. The proceeds will go to Aymestrey Church and Aymestrey Parish Hall.

The show will run for approximately 135 minutes, including a 20-minute interval and is recommended for ages 8+ as the Play contains scenes of peril, politics and passion! Younger children are welcome, if they're brave enough...

Bring your own seating/rug, suitable clothing & picnic. Only assistance dogs are permitted. Venue is wheelchair accessible by prior arrangement - email hello@alisonarcher.co.uk

Car parking is 200m from performance area.

The doors will open at 6pm and the performance starts at 7pm

To book your tickets visit: illyria.co.uk

Having a Garden Party?

Can't trust the weather?

Orleton Village Hall hires:

- **large easily erected marquee**
- **Large trestle Tables**
- **Plastic outdoor Chairs**

Contact: booking@orletonvillage.co.uk

Orleton Village

COME AND JOIN US FOR OUR

SUMMER FETE

SUNDAY 5th JULY

**Activities from
12noon to 4pm**



Dog Show – Stalls – Games
BBQ – Cakes – Ice cream – Bar – Cafe
Bouncy Castle – Hook a duck – Pets Corner
+ Village Calendar Photo Voting

CHILDREN'S WRISTBANDS - pay once
and play all afternoon in the children's area

August Coffee Mornings in St George's

With the regular Wednesday weekly Coffee Shop in the village hall taking a well-deserved rest during August, we invite you to join us in St. George's Church between 10.30 and 12 noon for coffee/tea and cake.

5th, 12th, 19th and 26th August
People of all ages are welcome.



A big thank you to the Ludlow Male Voice Choir

On Friday 12th June, we were delighted to welcome the Ludlow Male Voice Choir to sing in St George's Church.

Singing to an audience of getting on for 50 people, their wonderful voices sounded brilliant in the super acoustics of the Church.

With a wonderfully varied programme, there was something for everyone to enjoy.

We look forward to welcoming them again. Thank you to everyone involved in making it happen, and to everyone who came along.



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Every Wednesday 7PM-8PM

Orleton Village Hall

Contact: Ella Stanton-Warren

Number: 07968473955

Email: movewithella1@gmail.com

SO YOU SAY
CARRYING A HEAVY CAKE
TO THE TABLE WORKS
ON YOUR ABS AND
CORE STRENGTH?

YES...AND
REPEATEDLY
LIFTING A SLICE
TO YOUR MOUTH
TONES UP
BINGO
WINGS



Orleton Coffee Morning needs you!

Orleton holds a weekly coffee morning at our village hall on a **Wednesday morning at 10.30am-12 noon.**

We offer homemade bakes, hot drinks, and a friendly informal place to meet and chat.

We would love to welcome a few more folk onto our team of helpers.

Do you have a favourite bake you may like to share with us?

Enjoy meeting and greeting folk, and maybe you would like to help at a session on an occasional basis?

WE WOULD LOVE TO HEAR FROM YOU!

*Please contact our Chair Cathy Hardwick via email at:
cathy.hardwick@hotmail.co.uk*

We need photographs for the 2027

ORLETON CALENDAR

with the theme "A Natural Place to be"

Please submit no more than three images
to Orleton Village Shop with your details
by the 3rd July 2026

The entries will be judged by a public
vote in the Village Hall on Sunday 5th July.



ORLETON
2027
CALENDAR

With the work of local
photographers
chosen by a public vote

Annual Meeting of the Parish Council

In May the Parish Council held its annual meeting. This meeting is a statutory requirement during which the councillors elect their leadership, review governing policies, appoint people to fill voluntary support roles, and prepare the parish council for the municipal year ahead. Councillors Mark Simmons and Colin Mitchell were re-elected to the positions of Chairman and Vice Chairman, respectively. Other appointments included:

- Nomination to Orleton Village Hall Management Trustees: Cllr Mike Jones
- Representative to Orleton Recreation Association: Cllr Brian Powell
- Tree Officer: Nicola Goodman
- Footpaths Officers: Martin Bradford and Alex Green
- Councillor Liaison, Lengthsman: Cllr Colin Mitchell
- Councillor Liaison, Land Drainage: Cllr Mark Wetton
- Councillor Liaison, Internal Audit: Cllr Mark Simmons
- Councillor Liaison, Road Safety and Highways: Cllr Mike Tipping
- Councillor Liaisons, Planning: Cllr Brian Powell with Cllr Mike Jones providing back-up
- Councillor Liaison, Defibrillators: Cllr Mike Jones

Also at the May meeting, councillors approved a revised Donations and Grants Policy, which aims to support local organisations, charities, and community initiatives through the provision of modest monetary donations. The guidelines and application form are online at <https://orleton-pc.gov.uk/policy-documents> or can be requested from the Clerk.

Ward Boundary Changes

The Local Government Boundary Commission for England (LGBCE) is reviewing the electoral arrangements for Herefordshire Council. While the LGBCE is recommending no change to the number of county councillors, they are recommending that Richards Castle Parish be transferred from Bircher Ward (which also includes Orleton, Yarpole Group, and Kingsland parishes) to Mortimer Ward (which includes Aymestrey, Wigmore Group, Leintwardine Group, Border Group, and Stapleton Group parishes). The LGBCE believes that this would provide for better electoral equality across the wards, but they are also asking people to submit their own comments on the proposal. They are particularly interested in evidence of community ties across the current and proposed wards.

The Parish Council has submitted a response objecting to the proposed boundary change. For more information on the proposals and to submit a comment, either in favour of or against them, visit <https://www.lgbce.org.uk/all-reviews/herefordshire>. The deadline to respond is **6 July 2026**.

Next Meeting

The next meeting of the Parish Council will be on **Thursday, 16 July** in Orleton Village Hall at 6pm. Residents are encouraged to attend. Please note that there is no meeting scheduled for August.

To contact the clerk or any of your parish councillors, please e-mail clerk@orleton-pc.gov.uk.

Stacy Perry, Clerk, Orleton Parish Council –
15 June 2026

Orleton Craft Group



We meet on the first and third Thursday afternoons in Orleton Village Small Hall, £4 per session.

Our Crafternoons run from 1:30 to 4:30, bring along whatever you are working on, enjoy friendship, chat, tea and cake!

Orleton Village
SUMMER FETE
SUNDAY 5th JULY
SAVE THE DATE

Can you help us?
We need Volunteers to run stalls
and manage parking
email: orletonhandmade@gmail.com
And donations of second hand goods (no clothing)



SCENT IN THE GARDEN

On 26th May we were delighted to welcome back Timothy Walker, botanist and former Director of Oxford Botanic Garden

Timothy first became interested in scent 25 years ago when Oxford Botanic Garden created an exhibit for Chelsea Flower show using plants with 'smelly' flowers, including the Voodoo lily, a member of the arum family which stinks of rotting flesh to attract its pollinators, carrion flies.

Plants produce scent to communicate, to attract pollinators and as a warning. Petals, sepals, anthers and pollen all produce a cocktail of scents in a flower. Sunflowers have 150 different molecules to attract bees. The bee orchid has a modified petal resembling a bee and produces a pheromone to attract them.

Scent is not restricted to flowers, many plants have scented leaves, pelargoniums, lemon verbena and eucalyptus. Schisandra has scented stems, the variegated horseradish a scented root and the bark of cinnamon is aromatic. It is thought that the evaporation of oil from the leaves of cistus aids heat reduction

Accompanied by a beautiful slideshow Timothy showed how we can enjoy scent in the garden throughout the year. In winter this can be provided by Chimonanthus, Sarcococca, Hamamelis, Viburnum

bodnantese "Dawn" and the vanilla scented Petasites. Spring brings azaleas, Philadelphus, Daphne bholua and Magnolia sinensis giving way to numerous scented summer plants, roses, honeysuckle, pineapple scented Cytisus battandieri and in late season the tiny primrose scented bells of Clematis rhederiana.

Timothy reminded us that scented plants do not just provide a perfumed haven for gardeners but are also of economic importance. Vanilla pods hail from Madagascar where the flowers have to be hand pollinated. Frankincense and myrrh are used in perfume production and lavender in aromatherapy. Scented leaved Artemisia annua grows in China, it is used to treat malaria and is responsible for saving 17000 lives annually.

On 17th May ODGC held a very successful plant sale at Orleton Village Hall. The club would like to thank everyone who contributed to the day, those who donated plants, helped man the stalls, provided refreshments and of course our thanks to our loyal customers.

On Tuesday July 28th we hold our AGM and Bring and Share Supper Orleton Village Hall. 7.30pm.

www.orletongardeningclub.co.uk

Mortimer Medical Practice – Patient Participation Group (PPG) Update, June 2026

Practice News

A number of changes have taken place in the Practice, including the departure of Practice Manager Fiona Harper. After five years with the Practice, Fiona left in May this year and Interim Practice Manager Gill Yip is covering the position while a replacement is recruited.

In other changes, receptionists Kim Rawlings and Raihgan Barker have both left the Practice, and interviews are currently taking place for their replacements. Anita Sharred, Practice Nurse, left on 26th May but the Practice was pleased to welcome back Charlotte Goodwin as a permanent member of the nursing team from 1st June.

Looking ahead, Dr Debra Corbett, Senior Partner, will be retiring in August this year. Dr Kemp will take over as Senior Partner, and the Practice will have just two partners going forwards, Dr Kemp & Dr Cadman-Davies.

Staff training afternoons will take place from 12noon on Tuesday, 14th July, and then again on Wednesday, 14th October.

Kingsland surgery and dispensary will open again from 4pm. Anima requests can still be submitted, and Reception reached in an emergency on 01568 708214.

Finally, for those who have previously asked, the Practice population now stands at 8,912. Covid Vaccinations Covid Spring Vaccination Clinics were attended by 700 patients. No more clinics are planned.

Cholesterol/diabetes Blood Checks Patients have queried whether both checks need to be fasting ones with nothing to eat for 10 hours prior to the test. Patients are advised that they do not need to fast for the diabetes test, and that the GP will inform the patient if they need to fast for the cholesterol test.

Total Triage (Anima)

Alison Harries (Deputy Practice Manager) is aware that calls to reception are often taking time to be answered as receptionists are busy filling out Anima requests. Recent staff departures have not helped this situation, but replacement receptionists should improve waiting times in the future. Staff pressure at the surgery also means that the planned Anima workshops are currently on hold with new dates to be announced in due course.

Did Not Attend (DNA)

In May, 128 appointments were missed without reason – that's 21 hours of lost clinical time.

The next PPG meeting is on Wednesday, 9th September, 2026.

In the meantime, if you have any issues or concerns you wish to raise about the Practice, please contact:
Kate Best (kate.mortimerppg@gmail.com),
or Simon Davies (simon.mortimerppg@gmail.com).